

1978

The first GPS satellite was launched in 1978 and GPS was originally developed only for military use

Never get lost

Personal Navigation Devices (PNDs) are slowly, but surely, getting popular in India. More players are entering this segment now than before with highly detailed maps. We take a look at 10 PNDs which you should give a thought

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Personal Navigation Devices (PND here on) are inbuilt in cars internationally. In India, there are very few cars which come with a GPS system on-board. And the ones that do, are priced at a premium. Coming to these car owners' rescue are personal navigation devices. Navigation is not just about going from source to destination. Present day GPS devices are filled with enough data to prevent you from ever getting lost. You no longer need to memorise complex routes in a city you are not familiar with or call anyone to find out the nearest restaurant in a locality that is new to you. In all probability, your PND will have all that data fed into it. The improved GPS chipsets such as SiRF III and above that were seen in most of the devices that we tested have an ability to lock your position faster and hold on to it even in low signal areas. We got devices

from four companies such as Garmin, Blaupunkt, MapMyIndia and SatGuide.

FEATURES

Garmin nuvi 215, 715 and 1460

Garmin sent us three GPS devices from the nuvi series namely nuvi 215, nuvi 715 and nuvi 1460. Screen sizes varied from 2.5-inch for nuvi 215, 4.3-inch for nuvi 715 and 5-inch for the nuvi 1460. They came pre-loaded with detailed maps of over 600 Indian cities.

The user interface on all Garmin devices is quite intuitive. The home page has just two main options such as **Where To** and **View Map** along with a volume controller and **Tools** menu. Tapping the ascending bars on the top left hand corner will open up a detailed view of the satellite signal strength, whereas on the top right hand corner you get an idea of the battery life.

Garmin provides a range of options when you enter the **Where To** menu. For starters, its Points of Interests (POI) section has as many as 14 categories

such as food and drink, fuel, transit, bank/atm, etc. There is more depth in each of these categories such as types of restaurants, types of attractions and you can also enter your own point of interest if you are confused about which category it might belong to.



MapMyIndia Vx140

Go Home option is a decent tool. Feed in your address and never bother about getting home from anywhere in your city. The map itself has many areas which are easy to understand after repeated use. You can toggle between 2D and 3D views while navigating. Speed indication, expected time of arrival, turn-by-turn voice navigation, visual representation of upcoming turns, etc. is visible on the map screen. With the 715 and 1460 which support Bluetooth you can even make and receive calls on your navigator by pairing it with your phone.

In the **Tools** section you come across a menu called **ecoRoute** which is a Garmin exclusive application that helps you drive more efficiently, by saving on unnecessary fuel loss. It can even generate reports after your trip giving you a details such as fuel spent, money spent, kilometers clocked among others.

SatGuide Mio 200, C230 and 560

We got three personal navigation devices from SatGuide namely Mio Moov 560, Mio Moov C230 and Mio Moov 200. Based on the old Windows CE version 5.0, the three devices have the SiRF Star III GPS chipsets.

Mio Moov 560 comprises a wide 4.7-inch TFT LCD screen and has six main options on the home page including a video viewer, audio player, headset and mobile phone apart from navigation. In short, the Moov 560 can be used as a mini entertainment centre in your car. It has a strong trapezoidal body with a gray metallic finish around the screen. It comes with an SD card slot at the top



SatGuide Mio Moov 560